

THAILAND

Although tea production is concentrated in a small area of the northern province, Thailand consistently produces excellent quality oolong, green, and black teas.

Bringing var. *sinensis* cuttings from Taiwan, the Chinese began to cultivate tea in Thailand in the 1960s. Thailand has since introduced new cultivars from Taiwanese cuttings suited to its cooler mountainous terroir. Tea is now grown in the northern provinces of Chiang Rai and Chiang Mei, in the Doi Mae Salong region in particular. Thai oolongs are produced in a similar way to Taiwanese rolled oolongs and typically have a medium level of oxidation. They are often described as having fragrant and grassy flavors with a creamy and nutty finish.

DOI MAE SALONG

Located near the Burmese border, this region is the center of tea production and has elevations over 4,000ft (1,200m). Oolong, green, and black teas are grown in this region.

SOUTHEAST ASIA



THAILAND KEY FACTS

GLOBAL TEA PRODUCTION:

1.7%

MAIN TYPES:

OOLONG,
GREEN, BLACK

FAMOUS FOR: FRAGRANT OOLONGS,
PARTNERSHIP WITH **TAIWAN** FOR
RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT

HARVEST:
MARCH–OCTOBER

ELEVATION:
MEDIUM

KEY



NOTABLE TEA-
PRODUCING REGIONS



AREA OF PRODUCTION